

Writing Warm-Up

Year-Long Programme

40 Weeks · 4 Terms · 160 Lessons · Daily 10–15 min warm-ups

Monday – Thursday structured lessons + Friday assessment & quiz

40

Weeks

160

Lessons

4

Terms

320

Quiz Questions

A complete, curriculum-aligned writing warm-up programme for New Zealand Years 5–6 classrooms. Each 10–15 minute lesson follows a proven gradual-release model — teacher-led demonstration, guided class practice, and independent student application — building writing craft systematically across the full year through a carefully designed spiral curriculum.

Year Level	NZ Years 5–6 (Phase 2 Writing)
Lesson Duration	10–15 minutes daily, Monday–Thursday
Friday Assessment	Weekly quiz (team game-show format) + writing task
Teaching Model	I Do / We Do / You Do (gradual release)
Curriculum Alignment	NZ English Curriculum — Writing Strand
Structure	Spiral: each skill revisited once per term in a new context

Why This Programme?

Many schools struggle to find a structured, daily approach to writing craft that fits within a busy timetable and builds consistently over the full year. Writing Warm-Up solves this with a complete, ready-to-teach programme that requires no preparation — every lesson is fully scripted with examples, guided practice sentences, and independent tasks.

Structured Daily Routine

Each lesson fits within 15 minutes and follows the same predictable I Do / We Do / You Do structure. Students know what to expect;

Spiral Design = Deep Learning

Every skill is taught four times — once per term — in a fresh writing context. Students revisit vocabulary, grammar, sentence building,

Complete Coverage of NZ Writing Curriculum

Every lesson maps directly to the NZ English Curriculum writing strand for Phase 2: sentence structures, punctuation, word classes,

Friday Assessment Built In

Each Friday a team-based quiz game show reviews the week's four lessons, followed by an independent writing task. 320 hardcoded

NZ Cultural Context Throughout

Example sentences, contexts, and vocabulary draw on NZ settings, te reo Māori, tikanga, and the NZ natural environment — making

Structured Daily Routine

Each lesson fits within 15 minutes and follows the same predictable I Do / We Do / You Do structure. Students know what to expect; teachers know what to deliver.

Spiral Design = Deep Learning

Every skill is taught four times — once per term — in a fresh writing context. Students revisit vocabulary, grammar, sentence building, and editing with increasing sophistication rather than moving on and forgetting.

Complete Coverage of NZ Writing Curriculum

Every lesson maps directly to the NZ English Curriculum writing strand for Phase 2: sentence structures, punctuation, word classes, editing, and purposeful vocabulary.

Friday Assessment Built In

Each Friday a team-based quiz game show reviews the week's four lessons, followed by an independent writing task. 320 hardcoded quiz questions — specific to each week — are included, with four plausible options that cannot be guessed by appearance alone.

NZ Cultural Context Throughout

Example sentences, contexts, and vocabulary draw on NZ settings, te reo Māori, tikanga, and the NZ natural environment — making the programme feel genuinely local rather than adapted from overseas resources.

The Teaching Model: I Do / We Do / You Do

Every lesson in the programme follows the gradual release of responsibility model — a research-backed approach that moves from explicit teacher modelling to supported practice to independent student application within a single 10–15 minute session.

Phase	Who Does the Work	What Happens	Time
I Do	Teacher	Teacher demonstrates the skill with clear examples and explanation. Students watch and listen.	3–4 min
We Do	Teacher + Class	Teacher works through practice sentences with the class. Students contribute answers and discuss choices.	4–5 min
You Do	Students	Students apply the skill independently to new sentences or a short writing task.	3–5 min

Each lesson includes:

- A clear skill title and curriculum objective
- Teacher instruction text for I Do — exactly what to say and show
- Example sentences with highlighted target features
- A demonstration explanation modelling the thinking process
- A tip students can use to remember and apply the skill
- 3 guided We Do sentences with a discussion prompt
- 3–4 independent You Do tasks with an optional Bonus challenge

The Friday Assessment

Friday is structured as a two-part weekly assessment: a team-based quiz game show reviewing all four lessons from the week, followed by an independent writing task that asks students to apply the week's skills in their own writing.

Quiz Game Show	Writing Task
8 questions — 2 per day of the week Hardcoded to each specific week's content 4 plausible answer options per question Options shuffle every game to prevent memorisation Team-based scoring with animated scoreboard Game show presentation mode for whole-class display	A contextualised writing prompt drawing on the week's four skill areas Student self-assessment checklist aligned to the week's skills Writing prompts vary across the year (narrative, recount, persuasive, descriptive) Self or peer assessment against teacher-defined criteria

Curriculum Alignment — NZ English (Phase 2 Writing)

All 160 lessons are mapped to the NZ English Curriculum Writing Strand for Years 5–6 (Phase 2). The programme targets the following curriculum foci:

- Using a range of sentence structures and punctuation for effect
- Applying knowledge of word classes: nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, pronouns, prepositions, conjunctions
- Editing writing for clarity, accuracy, and impact
- Building vocabulary across Tier 1 and Tier 2 word levels
- Producing writing that is purposeful, audience-aware, and well-structured
- Writing across text types: narrative, recount, information, persuasion, description

Skill Spiral — How Each Domain Progresses Across the Year

Skill Domain	Term 1	Term 2	Term 3	Term 4
Vocabulary	Descriptive adjectives & synonyms	Movement, roots & meaning spectations	Figurative language, connotation & figurative language	Formal, evaluative & academic language
Punctuation	Basics: . , ! ? apostrophe	Fronted clauses, brackets, dashes	Ellipses, em dashes, dialogue, full stops	Full review + advanced consolidation
Grammar — Nouns/Verbs	Nouns, action verbs, SVA	Collective, future, modals, relative pronouns	Count nouns, tense, pronouns	Gerunds, passive, tense mastery
Grammar — Adj/Adv	Adjectives & comparison	Comparative, adverbial phrases	Adjective placement, degree adverbs	Formal adverbs, verb forms
Conjunctions	Coordinating (FANBOYS)	Subordinating & relative pronouns	Narrative & informational use	Linking adverbs, full toolkit
Sentence Building	Simple, compound, expanding	Combining, complex, when/because	Cause-effect, show-don't-tell, sensory	Allegory in persuasive context
Sentence Openers	Fronted adverbials — time	Contrast & manner openers	Place & atmosphere openers	Full repertoire review
Paragraph Cohesion	Topic sentences & basic links	Pronoun linking devices	Time connectives, cohesion repeat	Argument cohesion & logical flow
Editing	Capitals, full stops, tense, run-on	Comma errors, bland verb upgrade	Dialogue, mood, narrative flow	Full self-edit, portfolio, voice & clarity

Term 1 — Week by Week

Wk	Monday — Vocabulary & Punctuation	Tuesday — Grammar	Wednesday — Sentence Building	Thursday — Editing & Craft
1	Tier 2 vocab: descriptive adjectives	Nouns & proper nouns	Simple sentence: subject + verb + object	Proofreading: capitals & full stops
2	Commas in lists	Verbs: action vs state	Expanding with adjectives	Editing: fixing run-on sentences
3	Synonyms: stronger words	Subject-verb agreement	Compound sentences: and/but/so	Editing: upgrading vague words
4	Apostrophes for possession	Pronouns: personal & possessive	Topic sentences for paragraphs	Checking pronoun-antecedent agreement
5	Exclamation & question marks	Adjectives: degrees of comparison	Sentence variety: short vs long	Peer-checking capitals & punctuation
6	Word families: roots/prefixes/suffixes	Adverbs: how, when, where	Adding who/where/when phrases	Tightening wordy sentences
7	Colons & semicolons — intro	Tense consistency: past & present	Complex sentences: main + subordinate clauses	Checking tense consistency
8	Homophones & confused words	Prepositional phrases	Fronted adverbials	Adding detail to bare sentences
9	Onomatopoeia & sound words	Conjunctions: coordinating vs subordinate	Paragraph cohesion	Removing repetition
10	Review: Term 1 punctuation	Review: Term 1 grammar	Review: Term 1 sentence types	Full-passage edit: Term 1 checklist

Term 2 — Week by Week

Wk	Monday — Vocabulary & Punctuation	Tuesday — Grammar	Wednesday — Sentence Building	Thursday — Editing & Craft
1	Tier 2 vocab: movement & action	Collective & abstract nouns	Simple sentences: action-verb focus	Capitals for proper nouns
2	Commas after fronted adverbials	Future tense: will / going to	Expanding with 'when' and 'because'	Editing: fixing comma splices
3	Antonyms & shades of meaning	SVA: tricky cases (everyone, each)	Compound sentences: new contexts	Upgrading bland verbs
4	Apostrophes for contraction	Relative pronouns: who/which/that	Topic sentences: persuasive purpose	Removing unnecessary apostrophes
5	Brackets & dashes	Comparative & superlative adjectives	Combining short sentences	Peer edit: punctuation variety
6	Greek & Latin roots	Adverbial phrases for time & manner	Who/where/when in persuasion	Replacing overused words ('nice', 'good')
7	Colons to introduce lists	Past & present progressive tenses	Complex: 'although', 'unless', 'while'	Checking tense consistency
8	Spelling: tricky high-frequency words	Prepositions of direction & movement	Fronted adverbials: time & contrast	Making vague sentences specific
9	Alliteration & assonance	Conjunctions review	Paragraph cohesion: pronoun links	Identifying weak sentence openings
10	Review: Term 2 punctuation	Review: Term 2 grammar	Review: Term 2 sentence structures	Full-passage edit: Term 2 checklist

Term 3 — Week by Week

Wk	Monday — Vocabulary & Punctuation	Tuesday — Grammar	Wednesday — Sentence Building	Thursday — Editing & Craft
1	Tier 2 vocab: feelings & emotion	Count vs non-count nouns	Simple sentences in narrative	Dialogue punctuation: speech marks
2	Commas: 'but', 'although'	Modal verbs: might/should/could	Show-don't-tell technique	Fixing poorly punctuated dialogue
3	Connotation: positive vs negative	SVA: collective nouns	Compound sentences: building tension	Upgrading adjectives for atmosphere
4	Apostrophes: tricky plurals (children's)	Pronoun reference: avoiding ambiguity	Narrative paragraph topic sentences	Pronoun clarity in narrative
5	Ellipsis for suspense	Adjective placement: before & after nouns	Sentence length for dramatic effect	Peer edit: punctuation for effect
6	Similes and metaphors	Adverbs of degree: 'very', 'quite'	Descriptive sentences: five senses	Cutting unnecessary adverbs ('very')
7	Semicolons to join related ideas	Present and past perfect tenses	Complex: 'because', 'after', 'before'	Improving cohesion between sentences
8	Spelling: suffixes (-tion, -ness, -ment)	Prepositional phrases for setting	Fronted adverbials: place & atmosphere	Strengthening narrative openings
9	Personification	Conjunctions review: narrative & info	Time connectives as links	Cutting filler words for impact
10	Review: Term 3 punctuation	Review: Term 3 grammar	Review: Term 3 sentence structures	Full-passage edit: Term 3 checklist

Term 4 — Week by Week

Wk	Monday — Vocabulary & Punctuation	Tuesday — Grammar	Wednesday — Sentence Building	Thursday — Editing & Craft
1	Tier 2 vocab: argument & opinion	Gerunds as subjects	Simple sentences: direct & concise	Report consistency: tense & parallel lists
2	Commas: advanced & embedded lists	Passive voice: introduction & purpose	Evidence + explanation (CEE structure)	Converting passive to active (or vice versa)
3	Formal vs informal vocabulary	SVA: final tricky cases	Compound sentences: building argument	Adjusting formality for audience
4	All apostrophe types: consolidation	Pronouns in formal writing: no first person	Concluding arguments: synthesis	Strengthening topic & concluding sentences
5	Hyphen, dash, ellipsis — full review	Infinitive, gerund, participle	Sentence variety: combining all types	Full peer edit: voice & clarity
6	Evaluative language ('significant', 'crucial')	Linking adverbs ('furthermore', 'however')	Varied sentence openings: full review	Replacing weak vocabulary in argument
7	Colons & semicolons: final practice	Tense consistency across text types	Complex sentences: full subordination	Improving argument cohesion
8	Spelling: year's tricky words	Prepositional phrases: all uses	Fronted adverbials: full repertoire	Full editing checklist (7 passes)
9	Language devices: year review	Grammar: year review challenge	Sentences: showcase & celebrate	Portfolio self-edit
10	Punctuation: year overview	Grammar: year overview	Sentence mastery: year showcase	End-of-year celebration edit

Sample Lesson — Term 1, Week 3, Wednesday

Sentence Building: Compound sentences using and, but, so

I DO

Instruction	A compound sentence joins two simple sentences using a coordinating conjunction — and, but, or so. Watch me build one.
Example	"She trained hard every day. She still felt unprepared." → "She trained hard every day, but she still felt unprepared."
Demonstration	"And" simply adds — the story moves forward. "But" creates contrast — something unexpected. "So" shows result — a conclusion follows. The conjunction you choose shapes the relationship between the two ideas.
Tip	Before picking a conjunction, decide: am I adding, contrasting, or showing a result? That decides which one fits.

WE DO

Instruction	Join each pair of sentences with the best conjunction. Add a comma before the conjunction.
Sentence 1	"The hākoī had been going for three days. The marchers showed no sign of stopping."
Sentence 2	"You can present your findings as a poster. You can create a short video."
Sentence 3	"The experiment failed the first time. The team learnt something valuable."
Prompt	What is the relationship between the two ideas? Does it add, contrast, or show a result?

YOU DO

Task 1	Write about a kaitiakitanga project using "so."
Task 2	Write about a time something went wrong using "yet."
Task 3	Write a sentence giving someone two choices using "or."
Bonus ♦	Write a paragraph about an environmental issue. Use at least three different FANBOYS conjunctions. Underline each one.

Sample Friday Quiz — Term 1, Week 3

Every Friday quiz has 8 questions — 2 from each day's lesson. All four options per question are similar in length and plausibility, so the answer cannot be guessed by appearance. Options shuffle each time the game is played.

Monday	"The water was cold" vs "The water was glacial." Why is "glacial" stronger?
A	A. It is longer, so it takes up more space on the page
B	B. It is a proper noun, which always sounds more impressive
C	C. It is far more intense — it paints a sharper, colder picture
D	D. It rhymes with other words, making the sentence musical
Tuesday	"The dogs barks at the cat." Why is this wrong?
A	A. "Dogs" needs a capital letter because it is specific
B	B. "Dogs" is plural, so the verb should be "bark" not "barks"
C	C. "Cat" should also be plural to match "dogs"
D	D. There should be a comma after "dogs"
Wednesday	"She trained hard every day, but she still felt unprepared." Where is the comma — and why is it correct?
A	A. Before "but" — because "but" joins two complete clauses and needs a comma
B	B. After "but" — because conjunctions are always followed by a comma
C	C. Before "still" — because adverbs need to be separated
D	D. After "day" — because fronted adverbials always take a comma
Thursday	"It was a nice day and we went to a nice beach." How many vague words need upgrading?
A	A. One — only the first "nice" is vague
B	B. Two — both uses of "nice" need upgrading
C	C. Three — "nice" (x2) and "went" are all vague
D	D. None — "nice" and "went" are perfectly precise words

Implementation

Time commitment	Each lesson is 10–15 minutes. Four lessons per week leaves Fridays for the quiz and writing task (~30–40 minutes). Total weekly commitment: approximately 70–80 minutes.
Preparation required	None. All lessons are fully scripted with examples, guided sentences, and tasks. The app displays everything on-screen for whole-class delivery.
Technology	Browser-based application. Runs on any device with a modern browser. Works on an interactive whiteboard, teacher laptop, or classroom display.
Friday quiz	Whole-class game-show format. Students work in teams. The quiz generates automatically for each week — no teacher setup required.
Assessment	Friday writing tasks can be self- or peer-assessed against the week's skill criteria. No formal marking is required, though work can be collected for portfolio evidence.
Differentiation	Bonus tasks in every You Do section extend more advanced learners. The graduated We Do → You Do structure supports all levels.
NZ context	All example sentences, contexts, and vocabulary use NZ settings, te reo Māori, and the NZ natural environment — no adaptation required.

What Teachers and Students Get

For Teachers

- 40-week complete programme — no planning
- Fully scripted I Do / We Do / You Do lessons
- Friday quiz auto-generated for every week
- Whole-class display mode
- NZ curriculum coverage documented
- No marking of daily tasks required

For Students

- Daily structured writing skill practice
- Clear, memorable tips for each skill
- Guided practice before independent work
- Friday game-show quiz — engaging and fun
- Writing skills that grow visibly over the year
- NZ contexts that feel relevant and real

Ready to bring structured writing craft to your classroom?

Writing Warm-Up — a complete, curriculum-aligned daily writing programme for NZ Years 5–6

Designed by a NZ educator for NZ classrooms